

Climate types

Humans live all over the planet, in climates ranging from tropical rainforests to cold deserts. Most of us live in areas that have good climates for growing food, but modern technology allows people to survive even in inhospitable climates, such as Antarctica. The cities and settlements featured here represent most of the climates of the world.

Paris, France

Temperate oceanic climate



Average highest temperature 78°F (26°C)
Average lowest temperature 35°F (2°C)
Total annual rainfall 24.4 in (620 mm)
Rainfall (wettest month) 2.7 in (69 mm)
Rainfall (driest month) 1.4 in (37 mm)

Although it has suffered some serious heat waves, Paris generally has the oceanic climate typical of western Europe, with rain throughout the year, mild winters, and warm summers. The urban area is mostly residential and commercial, but the surrounding countryside is ideal for growing food.

Sydney, Australia

Temperate oceanic climate



Average highest temperature 81°F (27°C)
Average lowest temperature 47°F (8°C)
Total annual rainfall 39 in (986 mm)
Rainfall (wettest month) 4.3 in (110 mm)
Rainfall (driest month) 1.9 in (48 mm)

Sydney lies in the path of the trade winds that blow from the southeast in the southern hemisphere. The winds blow off the ocean, which gives the city an oceanic climate, with lots of rain, mild winters, and cooler summers than the rest of Australia.

Vostock Station, Antarctica

Polar desert climate



Average highest temperature -26°F (-32°C)
Average lowest temperature -90°F (-68°C)
Total annual rainfall 0.2 in (5 mm)
Rainfall (wettest month) 0.03 in (1 mm)
Rainfall (driest month) 0 in (0 mm)

On July 21, 1983, scientists at Vostock Station at the heart of the east Antarctic ice sheet recorded a temperature of -128.6°F (-89.2°C), the lowest ever recorded anywhere on Earth. This is also one of the driest places on the planet.



Winnipeg, Canada

Continental climate



Average highest temperature 78°F (26°C)
Average lowest temperature -9°F (-23°C)
Total annual rainfall 21.8 in (555 mm)
Rainfall (wettest month) 3.5 in (88 mm)
Rainfall (driest month) 0.7 in (18 mm)

Located in the heart of Canada, Winnipeg has a continental climate, with less rain than oceanic regions, hot summers, and very cold winters. In 1879, the temperature plunged to a numbing -54°F (-47.8°C).

